

Gary Hyde

Full Stack Software Engineer Application

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Dear Tailscale Hiring Team,

I am applying for the Full Stack Software Engineer role because the way you describe the work is the way I already build. The web app and admin console want someone fluent in React and TypeScript who is just as comfortable behind the API, and that full-stack ownership is not a stretch for me. It is the default mode I have worked in for years: data model, API, and a frontend I would put my name on, all carried through by one person who saw the feature to the end.

React and TypeScript are where I live day to day. I built the booking and scheduling interface for Kora, the multi-tenant interfaces for TeeTimes, and the candidate portal for Pathara, all in React and TypeScript with strict typing throughout. None of those were frontend-only assignments. I owned each one full stack, from the PostgreSQL schema and the Node.js and Express services up to the UI, and shipped them without handing work across a boundary to a separate backend or frontend resource. That end-to-end habit is the thing I would bring to your web app and admin console on day one.

I want to be straight about the stack rather than oversell it. The frontend is squarely in my wheelhouse, and I own backend services in Node.js today, with REST APIs and background job pipelines on BullMQ and Redis. Go is the one piece I would be ramping into, not a language I already ship. I have built enough backends to recognize what a well-factored service looks like, and picking up a new backend language inside a real codebase with a good review loop is exactly the kind of ramp I expect to do well and quickly. I would rather tell you that plainly than claim experience I do not have.

The part of the job description that made me want to apply is the culture. Async-first, written-first, meetings that are rare and deliberate, decisions captured in writing so people can act on them later. I have worked remotely for over a decade, and the way I keep that working is by writing. I draft specs before I build, plans a teammate can pick up cold, and review summaries detailed enough that nobody needs a call to understand what changed and why. I treat documenting a decision as part of doing the work, from a custom Git commit convention I set up for traceability in a multi-developer ERP environment to a cross-system incident report that traced an in-

ventory overselling bug to its root cause. That is not a habit I would have to adopt for Tailscale. It is how I already operate, and it is why long focus blocks and a distributed team are a setting I do my best work in.

I would welcome the chance to talk through how I would ramp on the Go services and where I could own features end to end across the web app and console. Thank you for reading.

Sincerely, Gary Hyde